2016 World Rogaining Championships

Alice Springs – 23 & 24 July 2016

1. Background

The Australian Rogaining Association has been awarded the right to host the 14th World Rogaining Championships in 2016 (14WRC2016). This event will be held 90km East of Alice Springs in the Northern Territory on 23 and 24 July 2016. Details of the ARA's proposal to host this event can be found at http://rogaine.asn.au/images/pdf/ara%20proposal%20to%20conduct%202016%20wrc.pdf

This provides a unique opportunity for local Australian and New Zealand rogainers to compete in a WRC close to home and in (relatively) familiar terrain.

2. Entry Limitations

Whilst it is fantastic to get a WRC locally the reality is that not all Australasian rogainers who want to enter will be able to. There will be a limit on the number of people permitted to enter which will be somewhere between 700 and 1,000. The popularity of WRC's has been increasing considerably over recent years and with the last two WRCs held in Australasia (2006 and 2010) both being oversubscribed all expectations are that this event will be also.

3. Entry Criteria

A prequalification process for WRC's was introduced for 9WRC2010 and this has been further developed over the past few years. The entry criteria for 12WRC2014 can be found at http://www.rogaining.com/attachments/article/256/WRC%20Entry%20Criteria%20August%202013.pdf It is expected that the entry criteria for 14WRC2016 will be very similar. These criteria are quite complex and a, somewhat, simplified explanation is set out below.

There are two levels of Pre-Qualified Entrant (PQE)

3.1. Automatic PQE

If you are an automatic PQE and you lodge your entry during Phase 1 (the first two weeks after entries open) you **WILL** get an entry in the event. To be an automatic PQE you need a team member who meets at least one of the following:

- Be a previous; MO, WO or XO winner at a WRC
- Be in the first six places in your age/gender category in 12WRC2014 or 13WRC2015
- Be in the first three places in your age/gender category in the 2014 or 2015 European Rogaining Championships
- Be in the first two places in your age/gender category in the 2014 or 2015 Australasian or North American Rogaining Championships

- Be in the first two places in; MO, WO or XO of the national rogaining championships of an IRF member country in the two years immediately prior to entries opening. IRF members countries can be found at http://www.rogaining.com/contact-the-irf-council-and-executive/contacts/member-associations
- Be an IRF Councilor of Observer

3.2. Preferred PQE

If you are a preferred PQE and you lodge your entry during Phase 1 you are extremely likely to get an entry in the event and in the worst case you will get two opportunities at a balloted entry. At all WRCs held since entry criteria were introduced the number of PQEs entering in Phase 1 has been such that all preferred PQEs would have gained entry with several hundred PQE places remaining unclaimed.

To be a preferred PQE you need a team member who meets at least one of the following:

- Fill one of places seven to ten in your age/gender category in 12WRC2014 or 13WRC2015
- Fill one of places four or five in your age/gender category in the 2014 or 2015 European Rogaining Championships
- Fill third place in your age/gender category in the 2014 or 2015 Australasian or North American Rogaining Championships

3.3. Caveat

Note that not more than 50% of the entrant teams in any age/gender category in a pre-qualification event (rounded up to a whole number) can achieve PQE status from that event. Note also that whilst all UltraVet teams are automatically qualified for 12WRC2014 this will not be the case for 14WRC2016. UltraVets will have the same PQE process as all other age/gender categories.

3.4. Non-PQE Entrants

A minimum of 20% of available entries are reserved for non-PQE entrants. In addition, any PQE entry places unclaimed in Phase 1 are automatically available to non-PQE entrants. If the event is oversubscribed, as we expect 14WRC2016 will be, non-PQE entrants need both to have completed a 24-hour rogaine in the previous two years **and** submit their entry during Phase 1.

Note also that if the 14WRC2016 is oversubscribed in Phase 1 then up to 50% of the available non-PQE places must go to entrants from outside of Australasia if such people have entered.

A ballot process is used to allocate entry places in the case of an oversubscription in Phase 1.

3.5. Wildcards

Note that 10% of available places are reserved for wildcard entrants proposed by IRF members and the IRF. These generally go to people heavily involved in rogaine administration and/or event organisation or teams that did not prequalify but who would be expected to be competitive due to performances in similar sports.

4. Tips for Entrants

Below are a number of tips for people wanting to maximise their opportunity for gaining an entry in 14WRC2016:

- Keep a close eye on the event website when it is established so you know when the entries open. This is likely to be September 2015, approximately one month after 13WRC2015.
- Try for PQE status through the 2014 and 2015 Australasian Rogaining Championships to be held in Victoria and Northern Territory respectively
- Try for PQE status through the 2014 and 2015 World Rogaining Championships to be held in South Dakota and Finnish Lapland respectively
- Think seriously about attending the 2014 or 2015 North American Rogaining Championships where competition may be a little thinner than in Australasia
- Irrespective make sure you lodge your entry during Phase 1 because PQE status has no value beyond Phase 1 and if the event is oversubscribed Phase 1 entrants have preference over all others
- Make significant voluntary contributions to rogaining to position yourself for a possible wildcard